

Week 1: Module Overview and Python Basics

- **Key Concepts:**

- **The Environment:** Understanding GitHub Codespaces, the VS Code layout (Explorer, Extensions, Terminal), and the specific structure of a Jupyter Notebook (Markdown vs. Code cells, Kernels).
- **Data Types:** The distinction between integers (`int`), strings (`str`), floating-point numbers (`float`), lists (`list`), and booleans (`bool`).
- **Logic & Control Flow:** How computers make decisions (`if...else`) and how they automate repetitive tasks (iteration with `for`-loops).
- **Zero-based Indexing:** The specific way Python counts positions in sequences (strings and lists).
- *[Bonus]* **Precision:** The inherent imprecision of floating-point arithmetic (e.g., $0.1 + 0.2 \neq 0.3$), which is crucial for students to understand early.

- **Packages Introduced:**

- **No external libraries:** The focus is on the Standard Library modules of Python and the Jupyter Notebook features.

- **Coding Techniques:**

- **Variable Assignment:** Using `=` to store data and `type()` to inspect it.
- **Slicing:** Extracting subsets of data from strings and lists (e.g., `[0:4]`).
- **Formatting:** Using f-strings (formatted string literals) to embed variables into print statements (e.g., `f"Hello, {VariableX}!"`).
- **Comparison Operations:** Using `==` , `!=` , and `not` to generate Boolean values.
- **Debugging:** Recognizing `TypeError` when applying incompatible operations (e.g., `len()` on an integer).